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FREEMASONRY AT A GLANCE

Answers to 555 Questions

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Preface

*Explore and explore. Be neither chided
nor flattered out of your position of
perpetual inquiry.—Emerson.*



THIS is a book for the man in a hurry—the man who must get his information in capsule form or not at all. It makes no pretension to scholarship. The student of Freemasonry seeking subtlety and elaboration must look elsewhere.

The very character of the work makes unavoidable a seeming dogmatic finality to many of the answers that will be very offensive to the precise reader who likes careful shading between history and legend, between proved truth and enthusiastic conjecture. Such delicate discrimination was impossible within the scope and purpose of this book.

In Masonic tradition fact and fancy are inextricably mixed. The atmosphere of secrecy that has always enveloped the Order is largely responsible for this condition. Even Benjamin Franklin, conspicuous as he was in Masonic

leadership, makes no mention of the Craft in his Autobiography. Much of what passes as "Masonic history" must be taken with a grain of salt. Fortunately the validity of Masonic teaching does not rest upon historical accuracy.

As to Masonic symbolism, there is no orthodox interpretation. The explanations given herein are only suggestive. Every Mason is privileged to interpret the symbols in the light of his own education, experience and spiritual discernment.

So far as possible the trite and well-worn explanations of the ritual have been omitted. The effort has been made to catch and answer the spontaneous queries of the thoughtful young Mason still athrill with the wonder and novelty of it all.

If the fascination, the wealth and variety of Masonic lore have been demonstrated in this happy-go-lucky compendium, and the young Mason stimulated to personal research, the compiler is more than satisfied.

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THE MASON AND THE LODGE



*Ours is a faith
Taught by no priest, but by our beating hearts:
Faith to each other; the fidelity
Of men whose pulse leaps with kindred fire,
Who in the flash of eyes, the clasp of hands,
Nay, in the silent bodily presence, feel
The mystic stirrings of a common life
That makes the many one.*

Anon.



1—What is Freemasonry?

A science of morality, veiled in allegory and illustrated by symbols. (Mackey).



2—What other definitions of Freemasonry have been given?

A school of instruction (Buck), a building of human souls (MacBride), a spiritual building (Green), a quest after the divine (Waite).



3—What is the meaning of the word, Mason.

Derived from the mediæval Latin, maconner, to build, or maconetus, a builder. (Mackey).



4—What are the secrets of Masonry?

There has been much discussion of this question by Masonic writers. Mackey asserts: "the only real apor-rheta (holy things) of Freemasonry are the modes of recognition, and the peculiar and distinctive ceremonies of the Order; and to these last it is claimed that reference may be publicly made for the purpose of scientific investigation, provided that the reference be so made as to be obscure to the profane, and intelligible only to the initiated."



5—Why do Masons speak of non-Masons as "profane"?

Because they have not been initiated into the mysteries. Literally profane means—outside the temple.



6—Under what conditions may a Mason solicit a "profane" to submit his petition to the Lodge?

Never, under any circumstances.

7—Why is solicitation strictly forbidden?

Because each petitioner must affirm that he comes of his own freewill and accord.



8—What does the Lodge represent?

Said to represent King Solomon's temple which was the symbol of the Universe.



9—What Is the Lodge of the Holy Saints John?

Masonic tradition holds that the mother Masonic lodge met at Jerusalem. This lodge was dedicated to St. John the Baptist and St. John the Evangelist. All Masonic lodges are figuratively supposed to be descended from this Lodge. It also has a mystic significance.



10—Why are Symbolic Lodges called Blue Lodges?

"Blue Lodge" is a popular designation for Symbolic Lodges, so called because the Lodge is covered with a blue canopy signifying the blue vault of heaven.



11—What does the starry ceiling of the Lodge represent?

The canopy of heaven.



12—What is the significance of blue?

Friendship, fidelity, universal sympathy.



13—What significance did blue have among the ancients?

Blue occupied an important part in the ritualistic observances of the Hebrews. See Exodus chapters 26, 28 and 39. The word for blue was a derivative of perfection. Among the Druids blue was the symbol of truth. The Egyptians wrapped their principal god, Amun, in blue; and the Babylonians clothed their idols in the same sacred color. The Hindoos associate blue with the god, Vishnu, representing wisdom.



14—What is meant by opening a lodge in the center?

An English phrase indicating a lodge of Master Masons. All the brethren present being Master Masons are equally near and equally distant from the imaginary point that symbolizes perfection.



15—Which is the correct usage, "Masonry" or "Freemasonry"?

Either is correct, but preference might well be given to "Freemasonry," which more nearly conforms to the

fact. "Masonry" has reference to builders, and may be applied to all so engaged. Certain guilds of builders in the Middle Ages were called "Freemasons," but now the word applies only to members of our Fraternity, so that where the former word might be misconstrued, the latter is instantly understood.



16—Why is the Lodge floor an oblong square?

Because of its measurement: east and west 360 degrees, north and south 180 degrees.



17—What does the phrase "ample form" mean?

When a Lodge is opened in the presence of the Grand Master, or when he performs any Masonic ceremony, it is said to be done in ample form.



18—Why is the North held to be the place of darkness?

Because King Solomon's Temple was built so far north of the ecliptic that the sun and moon at their meridian height, shone only upon the East, South and West, leaving the North in darkness.



19—What is the proper title to be given to a Grand Lodge and its presiding officer, the Grand Master?

Most Worshipful, except in Pennsylvania where it is Right Worshipful. Right Worshipful is the title applied to all other officers in American Grand Lodges.



20—What is a clandestine lodge?

A lodge purporting to be Masonic but not recognized by a regular Grand Lodge. (Also see Question 375.)



21—What is the meaning of Just, Perfect and Regular when applied to a Lodge?

A Lodge is Just when it is furnished with the Three Great Lights, Perfect when it contains the constitutional number of members, Regular when it is working under a charter or Warrant of Constitution from a Grand Lodge.



22—What jewels do Lodge officers wear?

W. M., square; S. W., level; J. W., plumb; Treas., cross keys; Sec., cross pens; S. D., square and compasses, sun in centre; J. D., sq. and comp., moon in centre; Stewd., cornucopia; Tyler, cross swords.

23—Who are the Holy Saints John?

St. John the Baptist and St. John the Evangelist.



24—Who are the patron saints of Freemasonry?

St. John the Baptist, St. John the Evangelist.



25—What are their festival dates?

The Baptist, June 24; the Evangelist, Dec. 27.



26—Was St. John the Evangelist an Essene?

Mackey asserts "there is little doubt that St. John was an Essene."

THE E. A. DEGREE

"Give me not millions," cried Mitya, in The Brothers Karamazov, "but answers to my questions."

27—What is the keyword to the First Degree?

Obedience.



28—What periods of life are represented by the three degrees?

Youth, maturity, old age.



29—What is one of the earliest lessons taught the candidate?

One of the fundamental teachings of our society: That all men are equal.



30—What virtues are developed by secrecy?

Self-discipline, reticence, self-command, self-reliance.



31—What does the rite of disalcation denote?

Reverence.



32—Why three knocks?

Ask, Seek, Knock. See Matt. 7:7.



33—What is the meaning of Jachin?

In strength.

What is the meaning of Boaz?

God will establish.

34—What are the arts, parts and points of Freemasonry?

The rules and regulations of the Craft, and the obligation to live morally.



35—Of what is the breast a symbol in Masonry?

Love, faithfulness, purity and character.



36—What is the length of my CT?

The scope of man's reasonable ability. (Definition of Baltimore Masonic Convention, 1842.)



37—What is the symbolical meaning of the CT?

The sacredness of a vow.



38—Has the cable tow any significance outside Freemasonry?

Yes; the cable tow was used by the Druids, the Brahmins, and the Greeks in their religious ceremonies.



39—What are some of the symbolical interpretations of the rite of circumambulation?

A mystic journey; an imitation of the course of the sun; development of civilization; analogy of Masonic progress.



40—What is the meaning of the imagery in the beautiful passage: "or ever the silver cord be loosed," etc.?

Silver cord, spinal marrow; loosed, collapse of nervous system; golden bowl, the brain; pitcher, the great vein carrying blood to heart; wheel, great artery that receives blood from heart; cistern, the heart (Dr. Clarke).



41—Why does the Mason face the East?

Because from the East comes the light. A Mason is presumed ever to have his face toward the light, indicative of his willingness to accept the truth.



42—Is there any Scriptural authority for facing the East?

Yes: see Ezekiel 43:2, "the glory of the God of Israel came from the way of the East."



43—In what form are Altars builded?

The form of a cube.



44—To what god of mythology was the cube sacred?

Apollo.

45—Why is the Altar placed in the center of the lodge?

To symbolize that Masonry is not a religion but a worship in which all men can unite.



46—Is an Altar used in English Craft Lodges?

No.



47—Why were ancient altars provided with horns?

A fugitive fleeing from an enemy was safe from molestation while he clung to the horns of the altar;—the altar provided sanctuary.



48—Where were the “fixed lights”?

In the East, West and South.



49—When should the terms “compass” and “compasses” be used?

Compass—to indicate the cardinal points; compasses—a geometrical instrument.



50—What are the Cardinal Points and their meaning?

E., Wisdom; W., Strength; S., Beauty; N., Darkness.



51—Are words, grips and tokens peculiar to Freemasonry?

No; the language of signs and symbols is older than history.



52—What punishment follows unfaithfulness to pledged word?

Remorse of conscience; exile from the fellowship of true and worthy men.



53—What civic virtue is inculcated in this degree?

Freedom under law.



54—Of what French phrase is “due guard” said to be a corruption?

Dieu me garde,—meaning, God protect me.



55—What does “I Hail!” mean?

“I Hail!” is a corruption of the true salutation which is “I Hele!” “Hele” is an old Anglo-Saxon word meaning to cover, to conceal.



56—Is there an “Order of the Star and Garter”?

No: this wording is incorrect.

57—What is the Garter?

The most illustrious order of knighthood in England, established traditionally by Richard I, (reigned 1189 to 1199), but actually founded by King Edward III about 1348.



58—What is the Golden Fleece?

An order of knighthood established by Philip, Duke of Burgundy, 1429.



59—What are three meanings of the Apron?

Is an inheritance from the immemorial past; is the badge of a Mason; is an emblem of innocence.



60—Is the Apron truly an ancient symbol?

The apron was worn by the superior orders of the Hebrew priesthood in the most ancient times. The ancient religions of India, Persia and Egypt held the apron a sacred emblem.



61—In what great mystery religions was the Apron used symbolically?

The mysteries of Mithra, the Essenes, the Druids and the Egyptians.



62—Was the Apron used by the Romans?

Festus declares: "the priests of the Romans were accustomed to wear white garments when they sacrificed."



63—What condition is symbolized in this degree?

The condition of the candidate regarding the new life he wishes to enter.



64—What is the meaning of an important ceremony?

To teach charity.



65—What significance is attached to metals?

Astrologers taught that possession of a metal put one under the control of the corresponding planet; lead—Saturn, iron—Mars, copper—Venus, gold—the sun. Divested of metals the candidate could bring no sinister planetary influence into the lodge.



66—What are the ornaments of a Lodge?

The Mosaic Pavement, The Indented Tessel and the Blazing Star.

67—What are the furnishings of the Lodge?

Holy Bible, Square and Compasses, and Charter.



68—What is a trestle board?

Board upon which the Master inscribes the designs for the guidance of the Craft.



69—What is the difference between a trestle board and a tracing board?

The Tracing Board is a picture formerly drawn on the floor of the lodge. It contains the delineation of the symbols of the degree to which it belongs. The trestle board is found only in the E.A. degree; the tracing board in each degree.



70—What is the meaning of the Gavel?

It is a symbol of labor and power.



71—How long was an ancient Operative Apprentice bound by a bond or indenture?

Seven years.

THE F. C. DEGREE

Ignorance is an outlaw, to be everywhere smitten with the sword and dagger of truth.—Albert Pike.

72—What is the keyword to the Second Degree?

Knowledge.



73—Why is so long a time required between the conferring of the degrees?

Masonry is a course of instruction in morals and philosophy and time must be allowed for the attainment of proficiency before further advancement.



74—How and when did the Second Degree originate?

Between 1723 and 1738 by dividing the First Degree.



75—What does "Fellow Craft" mean?

Fellow or Companion of the Craft.



76—When was the term "Fellow Craft" first used?

In Scotland in 1598; in England in 1723.

77—What part does the Second Degree occupy in Ancient Craft Masonry?

Ceremonies of the Second Degree originally were part of the First Degree of Initiation.



78—Who revised and enlarged the Second Degree?

William Preston, about 1770.



79—What was Preston's idea in the formation of the lecture of the Second Degree?

To make Masonic ritual actually an instruction course in the arts and sciences.



80—Who was Amos?

Flourished about 760 B. C. Called the "first great social reformer in history."



81—What interpretation of the oblong square may be made?

That Masonry is progressive and each Mason must try his life by the Perfect Square.



82—What are the movable jewels?

The Rough and Perfect Ashlars and the Trestle Board.



83—What are the immovable jewels?

Square, level, plumb.



84—What was Operative Masonry?

Fraternities of builders in the early middle ages who actually erected buildings.



85—What is Speculative Masonry?

Speculative Masonry is the application of the art of Operative Masonry to the teaching of morality and science. The Operative branch of our Institution was the forerunner and origin of the Speculative.



86—Why did Operative Masonry decline?

Operative Masonry concerned itself largely with erecting cathedrals. With the Reformation cathedral-building declined.



87—How did Operative Masonry become Speculative?

A gradual process. Scholars and thinkers were attracted by the venerable traditions and impressive sym-

bolism of Operative Masonry. Masonry became wholly speculative about 1717.



88—Where did the pillars originate?

Hiram Abiff brought them from the temple of Hercules and Astarte in Tyre. The Phoenicians took them from the Egyptians, who obtained them from ancient India.



89—What is the meaning of the pillars, according to Preston?

Represent the Pillar of Cloud and the Pillar of Fire by which the Israelites were guided.



90—What originally rested on the pillars?

An egg: the globes are a modern innovation.



91—What do the globes represent?

The heavens and the earth; also astronomy and geography.



92—What do the globes symbolize?

The universe.



93—Whence came the lilywork on the pillars?

On the Egyptian pillars the lilywork was in the form of the lotus, a flower not indigenous to Egypt but as a symbol accepted by them from India, and represents humanity, universality and at times the passive or feminine principle of life.



94—What is the meaning of the "Theological Ladder?"

Its seven rungs represent the three theological virtues of Faith, Hope and Charity, and the four cardinal virtues.



95—Of what is the Middle Chamber a symbol?

The place where rewards are given out.



96—Was there a middle chamber in King Solomon's temple?

Yes; see 1 Kings 6:8.



97—Why are there 15 steps?

The total of the sacred numbers; three, five, seven.

98—What is the symbolism of the Winding Stairs?

Progress, development, evolution.



99—What is the teaching of the five senses?

That our contacts with our fellows should be kindly, helpful and brotherly.



100—What are the five orders of architecture?

The Doric, the Ionic, the Corinthian, the Tuscan and the Composite.



101—What well-known building in Washington is a good example of Corinthian architecture?

The Capitol.



102—What was the cause of the Ephraimitish war?

The jealousy of the tribe of Ephraim.



103—What is the symbolism of corn, wine and oil?

Nourishment of mind and body, refreshment of soul; joy of achievement.



104—What does the letter G signify?

Geometry; also it is the symbol of Deity. Originally Freemasons used the Hebrew letter Yod.



105—When will men have learned the secret of the letter "G"?

When they attain to perfection.



106—What are some of the interpretations of the letter "G"?

Geometry, the Deity, the Square, ancient Egyptian snake emblem.



107—Why was "G" substituted for the Hebrew Yod?

Doubtless a corruption by ignorant Operatives.



108—What is the Pentalpha?

A five-pointed star reputed to have occult powers.

THE M. M. DEGREE

The great philosophers have taught us how to ask questions, not how to give answers.—H. Wildon Carr.

109—What is the key word of the Third Degree?
Achievement.



110—Why is the Third Degree called the Sublime Degree?

Because it offers the ultimate revelation of Masonic teaching, deals with Divine truths and presents the profoundest philosophy and religion.



111—When was the Third Degree incorporated into the ritual as a distinct degree?

Exact date unknown; probably between 1717 and 1730.



112—What splendid moral virtue is taught?
Fidelity unto death.



113—What is the supreme revelation?
Immortality.



114—Who was Tubal Cain?

Son of Zillah, one of Lameck's wives; lived about 3,800 B. C., "an instructor of every artificer in brass and iron."



115—Has Masonic business always been transacted in the Third Degree?

No; formerly business was transacted in the E. A. degree.



116—When and where was the first reference made to the Master's Degree?

In the General Regulations of 1720.



117—Why is the trowel most appropriate for the M. M. degree?

Because the Master Mason is a builder.



118—What does the M. M. build?

A mystic temple of Brotherhood.

119—How is this mystic temple builded?

By hopes, prayers and unselfish labor.



120—What does the Third Degree teach as to the meaning of life?

That life is a quest after the divine.



121—What are "foreign countries" to a Mason?

Any unknown land, intellectual or moral.



122—Do we find the idea of "the quest" in modern literature?

In "The Wandering Jew," by Eugene Sue; "The Blue Flower," by Henry Van Dyke; "The Blue Bird," by Maurice Maeterlinck.



123—What other illuminating illustrations may be suggested?

The stories of King Arthur, Parsifal, Sir Launfall, Ulysses.



124—What splendid symbols of the divine quest may be mentioned?

The Sacred Spear, The Holy Grail, The Lost Word.



125—What is the meaning of the acacia?

The immortality of the soul.



126—Is immortality the only significance of the acacia?

No; the acacia has symbolized innocence and initiation.



127—Is the acacia an ancient symbol?

Yes, the Hebrews always planted a sprig of acacia at the head of a grave of a departed friend. The ancients substituted the acacia for all other plants and flowers because they believed it was incorruptible and not subject to attacks by insects, thus symbolizing the incorruptibility of the soul.



128—What plants or shrubs took the place of the acacia in the ancient religions?

The lotus in the Brahmanic rites, the heath in Egypt, the myrtle in Greece, the mistletoe in the Druidic ceremonies.

129—What Masonic emblem is treated with scant respect by some Masonic scholars?

The Weeping Virgin, it being held that it is a quite recent innovation, not being found in Masonic symbolology in the eighteenth century.



130—To what does the symbol of the Weeping Virgin allude?

To Isis weeping over the body of Osiris.



131—When was the symbol of the Weeping Virgin introduced into Freemasonry?

Early nineteenth century.



132—By whom?

Jeremy Cross, noted New Hampshire ritualist.



133—What is the meaning of the Pot of Incense?

Prayer and the pure heart from which prayer ascends.



134—When was the Beehive introduced into Masonic symbolism?

At the time of the Great Schism.



135—What is the significance of the Book of Constitutions?

Obedience to law, loyalty and patriotism.



136—What means the sword to the heart?

Conscience; and that justice will be meted out unerringly to the wrongdoer.



137—What is the meaning of the Anchor and Ark?

Hope. The Anchor appears frequently upon the Christian tombs in the Catacombs of Rome; probably referring to Hebrews 6:19.



138—Where did Masonry get the hour glass?

Used by the ancient Egyptians in their religious processions as the astronomical emblem of time.



139—What does the Scythe teach?

That life is short, and we must labor while it is day.



140—What are the symbolical meanings of (a) the Square, (b) the Level, (c) the Plumb, (d) the

Rough Ashlar, (e) the Perfect Ashlar, (f) the Trestleboard?

(a) Morality, (b) equality, (c) uprightness, (d) uneducated man of sterling character, (e) educated, awakened man, (f) every source from which the Divine Will may be learned.



141—What is the meaning of the All-Seeing Eye?

The All-Seeing Eye symbolizes God as a Guardian and Protector of His children. See Psalms 34:15, Psalms 121:4, Proverbs 15:3.

The Egyptians represented Osiris, their chief deity, as an open eye.



142—What is the meaning of the Blazing Star?

Truth; also the Sun, hence, Enlightenment.

THE TEMPLE OF KING SOLOMON

*Ye are the temple of the living God; as God hath said, I will dwell in them, and walk in them; and I will be their God, and they shall be my people.—
2 Cor. 6:16*

143—When did Hiram Abiff arrive at Jerusalem?

In the year 1012 B. C.



144—Where was Solomon's Temple erected?

On a table of rock at Mount Moriah.



145—What influence did the temple have on the legends and history of early peoples?

Early became a moral and religious symbol, universally recognized.



146—What is the symbolical meaning of King Solomon's Temple?

Ancient tradition held that K. S. T. was the most perfect edifice ever erected, therefore symbolized perfect development of mind and character.



147—What sort of marks have been discovered on the foundation of King Solomon's Temple?

Marks of Phoenician Masons.

148—What was the name of the inner-most sanctuary?
The Holy of Holies.



149—What was the Sheldinah?

A glory that shone over the mercy seat, the symbol of the Presence of the Most High.



150—How long was the temple of Solomon in building?
Seven years and a half.



151—How high were the pillars of the porch in King Solomon's Temple?

27 ft. high, 18 ft. in circumference, 6 ft. in diameter.



152—What was the size of King Solomon's Temple?

According to Josephus—105 ft. long, 35 ft. wide, 210 ft. high.



153—How many men were employed in the erection of King Solomon's Temple?

Josephus declares 110,000 men.



154—What was the cost of the construction of King Solomon's Temple?

According to tradition, 108,000 talents of gold and 1,117,000 talents of silver, equivalent in modern money of approximately \$4,000,000,000, an incredible sum.



155—How long did the feast of the dedication of King Solomon's Temple continue?

Seven days.



156—Upon what did King Solomon stand when dedicating the temple?

Upon a brazen scaffold. See II Chron. 6:13.



157—What is the meaning of the alleged fact that in the building of the Temple there was heard not the sound of axe, hammer or any tool of iron?

That character is builded in the silence—that discordant sounds should not be permitted to disturb the harmony of the Masonic Lodge.



158—What is the significance of the Temple to the Mohammedans?

The Moslems describe the Temple as the "Centre of

the World" and "The Gate of Heaven," and they believe that Mohammed made his "ascent to heaven" from that spot.



159—What queen marvelled at the beauty and magnificence of King Solomon's Temple?

The Queen of Sheba.



160—Do Masons expect to ever rebuild Solomon's Temple?

No; the Temple that Speculative Masonry builds is a spiritual temple in the hearts and minds of men.



161—What do we mean by "building a spiritual temple," and in what famous play, written by a Mason, may be found a poetic description of the re-building of the temple?

A building of human souls; The Servant in the House, by Charles Rann Kennedy.

THE LOST WORD

*Who telleth one of my meanings
Is Master of all I am.—The Sphinx.*

162—What is the Lost Word of the Master?

The Lost Word is the symbol of divine truth for which the Mason is in search. (Mackey).



163—When will the Lost Word be recovered?

When man attains perfection.



164—Where may a clue be found to the meaning of the lost word?

John 1:1-5.



165—What is the sacred Tetragrammaton?

The four consonants YHWH, translated in our Old Testament as Jehovah, representing the "incommunicable name" of Deity.



166—What is the legend of the Tetragrammaton?

That at the time of the Exile the Hebrews lost the true pronunciation of the Deific name, and the four consonants YHWH became the substitute.

167—What is the peculiar custom of the Hebrews regarding the Tetragrammaton?

Being the incommunicable name, it was too holy to be pronounced. In its place the word "Adonay," meaning Lord, was used.



168—Did the Ancient Aryans have a sacred word?

Yes.



169—What was it?

AUM.



170—What does it mean?

The All-powerful, All-wise, All-loving and immanent Deity.



171—What further meaning attaches to the Hindoo syllable?

The first Sanscrit letter A represents God the Creator, U represents God the Preserver, M represents God the Destroyer.



172—What Hindoo gods are represented by these letters?

Brahma, Vishnu, Siva.



173—How did the Romans interpret A U M?

As "Artifex Universus Mundi," meaning "Architect of the Universe of the World."

THE LEGEND OF HIRAM

Once, by the mercy of God, a truth is born into the world, it can never be expelled. Nor can it be defeated. All who see it are thereafter conscripts in its service.—Joseph Fort Newton

174—When was the legend of the Third Degree first used?

Not definitely known. Early Masonic documents indicate that it was known and used in the seventeenth century.



175—What is the Master symbol of Blue Lodge symbolism?

The legend.

176—Has the legend of the Third Degree an historical basis?

No; it is purely legendary.

✧ ✧

177—Who was Hiram, King of Tyre?

He was a wise and noble monarch, and reigned for 34 years.

✧ ✧

178—Who was Hiram Abiff?

A Master Architect and Builder, subject of Hiram of Tyre; said to have been the Grand Master of the Dionysian Artificers.

✧ ✧

179—Is Hiram Abiff a purely legendary character?

No; see II Chron. 2:11-14.

✧ ✧

180—What does Hiram Abiff mean?

Hiram, my father.

✧ ✧

181—Have the Jews a tradition of the death of HA?

Yes.

✧ ✧

182—What does Hiram mean, symbolically?

Light, the Sun, Redeemer, the Perfect Man.

✧ ✧

183—Of what is H A a type?

Any apostle of light and liberty.

✧ ✧

184—What variation of Hiram is used in Masonic ritual?

Khurum or Khurum.

✧ ✧

185—Is there any recognized and generally accepted interpretation of the Hiram legend?

No; Dr. Oliver, a well-known Masonic writer of the early nineteenth century, lists fourteen distinct interpretations. Robert I. Clegg, the distinguished editor of Mackey's Encyclopedia, lists thirty or more.

✧ ✧

186—What are the best-known interpretations?

That it is historical, is an adaptation of the legend of Osiris, is an allegory of the setting sun, represents death of Abel by Cain, refers to expulsion of Adam from Eden, mourning of Joseph for Jacob, an astronomical allegory, death and resurrection of Jesus, violent death of Charles I, persecution of the Templars, political invention by

Cromwell, parable of old age and death, or drama of resurrection.



187—Who said, "I have never met tragedy so real, so sublime, so magnificent as the legend of Hiram"?
Edwin Booth.



188—What was the Mark of the medieval Mason?
The paw of a lion.



189—Why the lion's paw?

In India the lion stands for the divine spirit in man. The Egyptians used it as the symbol of the life-giving power of the sun. Among the Jews it was the emblem of the Tribe of Judah, from which was to come the Messiah. In Christian symbolism the Christ is called the Lion of the Tribe of Judah. For centuries the lion's paw has been used by Masons to indicate the perfected stone. Make your own application.



190—When did the lion symbolism originate?
In India in prehistoric times.



191—How was the lion used as a symbol by the Jews?
Emblem of the Tribe of Judah from which the Messiah was expected.



192—What did the lion symbolize to the Egyptians?
The life-giving power of the sun, especially in bringing the resurrection of vegetation in the spring.



193—Of what did early Masonry consider the lion a symbol?
Christ and the Resurrection.



194—What is the legend of Osiris?

Osiris, Lord of the Nile and Ruler of Eternity, labored with his sister-wife Isis for the good of man. Set Typhon, the Evil One, hated them. By a clever stratagem Typhon lured Osiris into a chest, which was quickly closed and flung into the Nile. Isis, heart-broken, set out to find the body, which had been carried to Syria, where it lodged against a shrub of tamarisk. She took the body back to Egypt, where Typhon again got possession of the body, mangled it beyond recognition and

scattered it. Meanwhile Horus, the god of Time, fought with and overcame Typhon. The body of Osiris is recovered, is lifted back to life by the strong grip of the lion's paw.

THE VOLUME OF SACRED LAW

Cherish good thoughts, searching, searching for them in books of wisdom, in sensible conversations, and above all, in your inner self.—Wisdom of the Brahmins.

195—What does V. S. L. mean?

Volume of the Sacred Law, signifying any Sacred Scriptures.



196—Why is a candidate obligated upon the Bible?

Because the Bible is the Holy Scriptures of the Christian and Jewish religions. Vows taken upon it have always been peculiarly sacred and binding.



197—Upon what book would a Parsee be obligated?

The Zend-Avesta, that being the V. S. L. of his religion.



198—Upon what V. S. L. is a Mohammedan obligated?

The Koran, it being the Holy Scriptures of his religion.



199—What is the V. S. L. of the Buddhists?

The Tripitaka, meaning three baskets, consisting of three parts, the first dealing with monastic discipline, the second contains preaching and dialogues, and the third treats of metaphysics.



200—Upon what V. S. L. would a Zoroastrian or Parsee be obligated?

The Zend-Avesta.



201—May a Jewish candidate be obligated upon the Old Testament alone?

In most jurisdictions, yes.



202—Is a Mason obligated to accept the Bible literally?
No.

203—How then must he accept the Bible?

As a rule of life; and as a symbol of God's revelation to man.



204—Where does the Bible rest in an English Lodge?

On the Master's pedestal.



205—Does Masonry teach that the Bible should be used in the public schools as a text book?

No; Masons are widely divided on this issue.



206—Does Masonry endorse the King James version?

Masonry endorses no particular version.

THE RELIGION OF FREEMASONRY

"PRACTICING OUT OF THE LODGE."

Seek truth, love truth, guard truth till death.—

John Huss.

207—Is Masonry a religion?

No; the Masonic fraternity is religious, using religious ceremonies to inculcate and re-enforce moral teachings but it makes no claim to being a religion; it rivals none.



208—What religious beliefs must a petitioner for the degrees of Freemasonry profess?

Belief in God and in the immortality of the soul.



209—Why does Masonry teach by symbols rather than by precept?

To arouse curiosity and stimulate study, and because the deepest truths cannot be defined in words.



210—Must a Mason believe in a personal God?

He must believe in Deity. No theological professions are required.



211—Does Masonry teach the personality of God?

Masonry enjoins no theological doctrines upon its members; but the teaching that God is a Father, tender and merciful, is implicit in its ritual.



212—Was Freemasonry ever Christian?

Yes; the Old Charges usually opened with a prayer to the Trinity.

213—Why are there no distinctively Christian symbols in modern Freemasonry?

Because Masonry is universal in its philosophy, ethics and religious teaching.



214—What is the meaning of the parallel lines?

The Holy Saints John.



215—What is the meaning of the point within a circle?

It has several meanings—the universe, fecundity, the Deity.



216—What three great schools of esoteric philosophy influenced Masonic thought?

Hermeticism, Kabalism and Rosicrucianism.



217—What is Hermeticism?

Relates to Hermes, early Egyptian divinity; used tools of builders' art as symbols of ethical truth; widely influential in ancient world.



218—What is Kabalism?

A philosophic school founded by Jewish rabbis at Alexandria, in which the Lost Name, Solomon's Temple, the Shekinah and other symbols well-known to Masons are used to teach a subtle mysticism.



219—What is Rosicrucianism?

A system of thought developed by the Brethren of the Rosy Cross presenting occult teachings by means of symbols familiar to Masons. It originated in the seventeenth century.



220—What is the crux ansata?

The Cross with the Handle; the Egyptian symbol of life. One of the earliest symbols of the trinity.



221—What is the meaning of the initials "G A O T U"?

Grand Architect of the Universe.



222—Why does a Mason pray?

Believing in the Deity it is but natural that he should offer supplication, adoration and aspiration.



223—To what moral principles are Masons dedicated?

Brotherly Love, Relief and Truth.

224—What is the five-fold duty of a Mason?

To God, his country, his family, himself and the fraternity.



225—How may the civic principles of Freemasonry be summarized?

Free thought; free schools; free speech; free religion; a free ballot.



226—If a Mason's daughter marries a non-Mason and later falls into distress, has she any claim upon the fraternity?

A daughter of a Mason in distress always has a claim on the fraternity no matter what may be her condition in life.



227 What amusements were forbidden to Operative Apprentices?

Cards, dice, gambling and attendance at questionable resorts, including taverns and ale-houses.



228—What does the Mason mean by "temperance"?

Self-control, self-discipline, keeping his passions in due bounds in all things.



229—What does the Mason mean by "fortitude"?

Courage, patience in adversity, calmness in trial, and faithfulness under all circumstances.



230—What does the Mason mean by "prudence"?

Common sense and reason.



231—What is Justice?

"The very cement and support of civil society."



232—What are the Cardinal Virtues?

Temperance, Fortitude, Prudence, Justice.

THE SACRED NUMBERS

*Nothing is more important than faith in spiritual values, for only by an appreciation of them do we build character able to withstand man's onslaughts.—
Los Angeles Graphic.*

233—What are the sacred numbers?

3, 5, 7 and 9.



234—What is the symbolism of the numbers?

According to the ancient belief, even numbers relate to earthly or human things, while odd numbers denote divine truth.



235—What is the symbolical meaning of Geometry?

Order, Universal Law, Science, Moral Rectitude, Spiritual Harmony, Divine Truth.



236—Who said: "God is always geometrizing"?

Plato.



237—What is the Forty-seventh Problem of Euclid?

That in any right angle triangle, the sum of the square of the two sides is equal to the square of the hypotenuse.



238—Who was Euclid?

A celebrated mathematician, lived in Alexandria 323-283 B. C. He is called "the father of Geometry."



239—What is the symbolic significance of the 47th Problem?

"The magnificence and unknowability of the Deity, while testifying to His universality, the simplicity of His truths and the wonders of His heavens and His earth."



240—Who said: "Geometry rightly treated is the knowledge of the Eternal"?

Plato.



241—Who said: "All things are in numbers; the world is a living arithmetic in its development—a realized geometry in its repose"?

Pythagoras.

242—Who was Pythagoras?

Grecian philosopher and mathematician; founded school at Crotona about 529 B. C. When Romans were commanded by the Delphic oracle to erect a statue to the wisest of the Greeks, they chose Pythagoras. He was an adept of the mysteries and a renowned traveller.



243—What are some of the significant "threes" in Freemasonry?

Three degrees, the principal officers, three original Grand Masters, three lesser lights, three Great Lights, three movable jewels, three immovable jewels, three who "traveled in a westerly direction," three raps, three gates, three circuits of the Lodge, three steps in Masonry.



244—What significant "fives" appear in Masonic symbolism?

Five Senses, five Orders of Architecture, Geometry, the fifth science, the five-pointed Star.



245—Why is seven of such significance?

Held in all ancient philosophies to be the symbol of perfection.



246—In Masonic ritual, what reference is made to Pythagoras?

He is called "our ancient friend and brother."

HOW DID IT ALL BEGIN?

*The wind that blows from the tombs of the Ancients
comes with gentle breath as over a mound of roses.*

—Goethe.

247—When did Freemasonry originate?

The origins of Freemasonry are lost in the dim vistas of history. The legends, ceremonies, symbolism and teachings of Freemasonry may be traced back through the mystery religions of antiquity to pre-historic times.



248—How old is Freemasonry?

Its rites, symbolism and teachings are of immemorial antiquity. Its ritual took its present form in the 18th century.

249—In primitive society was there any equivalent to Freemasonry?

Primitive tribes maintained an institution called "The Men's House," a sort of club house arrangement, into which boys were initiated by weird and terrorizing ceremonies upon attaining manhood.



250—Wherein is the similarity between the ceremonies of the ancient religions and those of Freemasonry?

Under the guise of a dramatic presentation of a legend the mysteries revealed the truth of the Oneness of God, the immortality of the soul and the brotherhood of man. Interwoven with the ritual were exhortations to morality and charity with a special stressing of fidelity as a pre-eminent virtue. Strict secrecy was enjoined upon the initiates under pain of terrible penalties for the violation of the oath.



251—What are the names of the ancient Mysteries from which it is said Freemasonry is descended?

Osiris (Egypt), Mithra (Persia), Adonis (Syria), Dionysus and Eleusis (Greece), Druids (Britain).



252—For what purpose were the Mysteries of the ancient world established?

Plato declared the Mysteries were established by men of great genius, to teach purity, ameliorate the cruelty of the race, refine its morals and manners and restrain society by the obligations of fraternity.



253—What were the teachings inculcated in the ancient Mysteries?

The ancient Mysteries presented symbolically, the two great ideas of death and resurrection; sometimes figured as darkness and light, sometimes as winter and summer, sometimes as defeat and later victory, but always holding the thought that something vital and life-giving has been lost and must be recovered.



254—What was the method of instruction in the Egyptian Mysteries?

A dead man was borne in a casket by a procession of initiates intoning a funeral dirge. On the third day the priests carried the coffin to the Nile. The sacred water was poured on the body, which came to life, and the ceremony culminated in rejoicing.

255—When were the Grecian or Eleusinian Mysteries established?

About 1800 B. C.



256—What did the Eleusinian Mystery represent?

Demeter and Persephone; depicted the death of Dionysius with stately ritual which led the neophyte from death into life and immortality. (Newton)



257—What were the moral teachings of the Eleusinian Mysteries?

The unity of God, the immutable necessity of morality, and life after death.



258—What was Mithraism?

The religion of Mithra, the sun god; flourished in Persia and Rome; was popular with the Roman army; was overwhelmed by Christianity.



259—What was the ceremonial of Mithraism?

Mithraism was a man's religion; its ceremonial consisted of seven degrees designated—lion, soldier, ox, eagle, old man, gryphon and the sun; in last degree the candidate was clothed with an apron and simulated one who was dead and is brought to life.



260—What did the Mithraic or Persian Mysteries celebrate?

The eclipse of the sun-god, using the signs of the Zodiac, the processions of the seasons, the death of nature and the birth of spring. (Newton)



261—What were the teachings of the Eleusinian Mysteries?

To live virtuously and happily and to die in the hope of a blessed futurity. (Cicero)



262—What famous Egyptian monument of Masonic interest stands in Central Park, New York?

Cleopatra's Needle.



263—Why is this obelisk of Masonic interest?

Because when it was moved from its place in Alexandria, Egypt, to be brought to the United States, there were found beneath it many Masonic emblems, includ-

ing a rough ashlar, a square, a plummet, a perfect ashlar, a trowel, and a white stone.



264—Who were the Dionysian Artificers?

A Phoenician society of architects and builders, workers in stone, and metal and precious stones.



265—Wherein are the Dionysian Artificers of interest to Masons?

Tyre was a principal seat of the Dionysian Artificers; undoubtedly Hiram Abiff was a member of the order; they lived under a secret constitution and discipline.



266—Briefly, what is the myth of Adonis?

Adonis was the son of Myrrha and Cinyras, King of Cyprus. He was an exceedingly beautiful youth and Venus fell in love with him and adopted him. Venus placed him in a coffer, unknown to the gods, and gave him to Proserpine to keep and nurture in the underworld. Proserpine became enamored with his beauty and desired to possess him. The controversy was referred to Jupiter who decreed that Adonis should have one-third of the year for himself, one-third with Proserpine and one-third with Venus. Later he offended Diana and was killed by a wild boar. Afterward he came back to life amid general rejoicing.

HIGH LIGHTS OF MASONIC HISTORY

*These men, whose lustre spreads from pole to pole,
Possessing every virtue of the soul,
All climes the Brotherhood adorn,
As smiling Phoebus gilds the Rosie Morn—*

—The Generous Freemason, 1731.

267—Who were the Collegia?

An ancient order of builders and workers in stone, metal, wood and fabrics, founded, according to tradition, about 650 B. C., in Rome.



268—Who were the Comacine Masters?

A body of architects of Como. It is believed they were the remnants of the Roman Collegia who fled to the island of Como at the fall of the Roman Empire, their descendants remaining a close corporate body were

recognized as Magistri Comanci by Rotharis, King of Lombardy, 634 A. D., and who spread ultimately over Europe. They were the forerunners of Freemasonry.



269—What is the York Assembly?

According to a commonly accepted tradition Prince Edwin summoned all the Masons in the realm to meet him in a congregation at York in the year 926. A General Grand Lodge with Prince Edwin as Grand Master was established, and the first Constitutions and Charges of Freemasonry were promulgated. These constitutions and charges compose the regulations that govern the Craft.



270—What is meant by Ancient Craft Masonry?

In the articles of union between the two Grand Lodges of England, adopted in 1813, it is declared that "pure Ancient Masonry consists of three degrees and no more; viz.: those of the Entered Apprentice, the Fellow Craft, and the Master Mason, including the Supreme Order of the Holy Royal Arch."



271—What were the colors of Ancient Craft Masonry?

E. A., white; F. C., blue; M. M., red.



272—What is the source of our information regarding Ancient Craft Masonry?

Manuscript documents known as the "Old Charges."



273—How many such documents are now in existence?
About 90.



274—What is the earliest document?

The Regius (Halliwell) M S circa 1390.



275—Where is the Regius M S at present?

The original is in the British Museum. A copy, possibly the only one in this country, is in the Iowa Masonic Library, Cedar Rapids.



276—What is the Regius M S like?

It is a "Poem of Moral Duties."



277—What historic Masonic document opens with a prayer to the Holy Trinity?

The Harleian M S. No. 1942, about A. D., 1670.

278—What is the Trinity College Tripos note?

An historic document, dated 1688, which speaks of the "Society of Freemasons," Dublin, Ireland.



279—What is the most recent document?

The Tunnah MS, of 1828.



280—How were brothers in the early days "made Masons?"

Simply by having the secret word entrusted to them.



281—Is Freemasonry an offspring of the medieval guilds?

This is widely disputed. Some Masonic scholars contend that modern Freemasonry is a direct descendant of the medieval guilds, others just as stoutly maintain that the line of descent is quite distinct.



282—Who was Jacques de Molay?

Last Grand Master of the Ancient Knights Templar; publicly burned at Paris, March 11, 1314.



283—What is the earliest recorded opposition to Freemasonry?

Under Henry VI of England a law was promulgated in 1425 forbidding Masons to confederate in Chapters and Congregations. The law, however, was not enforced.



284—What English Queen is said to have sent an armed force to dissolve a Grand Lodge?

Queen Elizabeth.



285—What lodge has the oldest Masonic lodge minutes?

Lodge of Edinburgh, Mary's Chapel, No. 1, has books beginning with the entry Dec. 28, 1598.



286—Who was John Boswell?

Laird of Auchinlech, Scotland, made a member of the Lodge of Edinburgh, June 8, 1600; first instance of a non-operative being made a Mason.



287—Is there any evidence that Masonry flourished in the seventeenth century?

Dr. Plot, the author of the Natural History of Staffordshire, written in 1686, declares that Freemasonry is "spread more or less all over the Nation."

288—Who was Elias Ashmole?

Elias Ashmole was a learned antiquarian who flourished in the seventeenth century. Born May 23, 1617; died May 18, 1692. He founded the Ashmolean Museum at Oxford. He was made a Freemason Oct. 16, 1646, and his diary records many meetings with Freemasons.



289—What great English architect was a Mason?

Sir Christopher Wren, born 1632, was known as Grand Master of Masons. Built St. Paul's Cathedral, London.



290—Who was Chevalier Andrew Michael Ramsay?

A Scottish scholar born 1686, adherent of the Stuarts; sought to revise Masonic ritual. When his revision was rejected by Grand Lodge of England he went to France where his degrees met with wide approval. Much of his ritual later was embodied in the A. & A. S. R.



291—When and where did modern Masonry originate?

June 24, 1717, when representatives of four London lodges met at Goose and Gridiron Tavern and founded the Grand Lodge of England.



292—Of the four old lodges that formed the Grand Lodge of England in 1717, how many still exist?

Three: Antiquity No. 2, Royal Somerset and Inverness, and the Fortitude and Cumberland lodge.



293—Does the Goose & Gridiron Alehouse, in which modern Masonry originated in 1717, still stand?

No; it was pulled down in 1893-4.



294—Where did the earlier English Lodges meet?

In taverns, these places offering the only conveniences for such meetings.



295—What were some of the curious names given to these taverns?

Bath Chair, Bristol; Busy Body, London; Cock and Bottle, London; Green Man and Bell, Jolly Coopers, Old Devil, Pope's Head, Ship Occasional, Wild Man.



296—Who was the first Grand Master after the Great Revival of 1717?

Mr. Anthony Sayre, Gentleman.

297—Who was Dr. Desaguliers?

An English scholar and ritualist, born Rochelle, France, 1683, driven out of France by persecutions, became Masonic leader in England, elected G. M., 1719.



298—What noted eighteenth century character is the subject of heated controversy among Masonic scholars?

Joseph Balsamo, better known as Cagliostro.



299—Who was Cagliostro?

A ritualist who flourished in the 18th century. His real name was Joseph Balsamo. He invented in 1777 a rite called Egyptian Masonry. He was sentenced by the Inquisition to perpetual imprisonment, and died in prison. Some Masonic scholars denounce him as an impostor; others hail him as a martyr.



300—Who were the Gormogons?

An anti-Masonic society, organized in 1723, in England.



301—What are Anderson's Old Charges?

The Old Charges, compiled by Dr. James Anderson, at the request of the G. M., 1721.



302—Who was Dr. James Anderson?

The compiler of the Old Charges; born 1684, died 1739.



303—In what year was the first Book of Constitutions published?

1723.



304—When did Martin Clare write the "Defense of Masonry"?

1730.



305—Who published the "Freemason's Monitor"?

Thomas Smith Webb in 1797.



306—What is the meaning of the Masonic term "Ahiman Rezon"?

The secrets of a prepared brother or Faithful Brother Secretary.

307—What historic Masonic work bears the name “Ahiman Rezon”?

The Book of Constitutions of the Antients, compiled by Laurence Dermott.



308—Who was Laurence Dermott?

The great protagonist of the Antients; born 1720, died 1791; compiled the Ahiman Rezon, the Constitutions of the Antients.



309—Who were the “Antients”?

A group of insurgent Irish Masons who formed a rival Grand Lodge in London in 1751, and called themselves the “antients” on the ground that they were reviving ancient Masonry.



310—Who were the “Moderns”?

The “ancients” in derision dubbed the supporters of the regular Grand Lodge “moderns.”



311—What were the differences between the Ancients and the Moderns?

The causes of The Great Schism are obscure, but from hints and intimations found in contemporary Masonic literature, it is assumed that the controversy turned about minutia of ceremonial, and modes of recognition. All writers seem to agree that the differences were unimportant.



312—When were they reconciled?

The two rival Grand Lodges were reconciled in 1813 under designation: “The United Grand Lodge of England,” and it continues to this day.



313—Who was Leo Taxil?

Frenchman, born 1854—true name was Gabriel Jougand-Pages. He pretended conversion to Roman Catholicism and produced a purported expose of Freemasonry.

MASONRY IN THE AMERICAN REVOLUTION

*Great men have been among us, hands that penned
And tongues that uttered wisdom.—Wordsworth.*

314—What Revolutionary martyr was a Mason?

Nathan Hale, executed 1776; made a Mason in St. John's Lodge, Portsmouth, N. H.



315—Who was the Masonic hero of Bunker Hill?

Gen. Joseph Warren who was killed at Bunker Hill. He was commissioned G. M. of Masons in Boston in 1769.



316—What old Boston tavern is famous in Masonic tradition?

Green Dragon Tavern; called by Webster "the headquarters of the Revolution."



317—What is its interest to Masonry?

It was the meeting place of St. Andrews Lodge, the members of which, it is said, planned and carried out the Boston Tea Party.



318—What reason have we for believing the members of St. Andrews Lodge were implicated in the Boston Tea Party?

The lodge record of Nov. 30, 1772, bears a note: "N. B.: Consignees of Tea took up the brethren's time." On Dec. 16 the record ends abruptly and the page is filled with the letter T.



319—What famous Masons were members of St. Andrews Lodge?

Paul Revere and Joseph Warren.



320—What ride made a Grand Master of Masons famous?

Ride of Paul Revere, immortalized by Longfellow.



321—What conspicuous position in Freemasonry did Paul Revere occupy?

Was Grand Master of Mass. from Dec. 12, 1794 to December 27, 1797.

322—What two famous men of Revolutionary Days were initiated before they reached their twenty-first birthday?

George Washington and Nathan Hale.

✧ ✧

323—When was Washington made a Mason?

E. A., Nov. 4, 1752; F. C., March 3, 1753; M. M., Aug. 4, 1753.

✧ ✧

324—When was Washington Master of his lodge?
1788.

✧ ✧

325—Does any Grand Lodge cherish a relic of Washington?

Yes; the Grand Lodge of Massachusetts possesses a lock of hair from the brow of George Washington. It was presented to the Lodge by Martha Washington and is kept in a golden urn.

✧ ✧

326—What famous generals on Washington's staff were Masons?

Among others, Greene, Lee, Marion, Sullivan, Rufus and Israel Putnam, Edwards, Jackson, Gist, Baron Steuben, Baron DeKalb, and Lafayette.

✧ ✧

327—What other famous Revolutionary heroes were Masons?

Gen. David Wooster, Gen. Nicholas Herkimer, Gen. Hugh Mercer, Gen. John P. G. Muhlenberg, Stephen Girard, James Otis, Edmund Randolph, Peyton Randolph, Robert R. Livingston, Alexander Hamilton.

✧ ✧

328—What distinguished French officer in the Revolutionary War was a Mason?

Lafayette.

✧ ✧

329—Who presented Washington with a beautifully embroidered satin apron?

Lafayette. The apron was made by Madame Lafayette.

✧ ✧

330—Has any American Lodge a relic of Lafayette?

Yes; Friendship Lodge, No. 9, Charleston, S. C., possesses the jewel he wore as Grand Master of France.

331—What famous American diplomat was very prominent in Masonry yet in his autobiography made no mention of his Masonic work or affiliations?
Benjamin Franklin.



332—What well-known Masons are noted among the signers of the Declaration of Independence?

Benjamin Franklin, William Hooper, Matthew Thornton, William Whipple, John Hancock, Philip Livingston, Thomas Nelson, Roger Sherman, Josiah Bartlett.



333—The corner-stone of what historic Federal building was laid with Masonic ceremonies in September, 1793?

George Washington laid the corner-stone of the Capitol on Sept. 18, 1793, with Masonic ceremonies.



334—What earnest Mason was known as the “father of the American navy”?

John Paul Jones.



335—Who was Capt. McKinsty?

An American captain in the Revolutionary War, captured by the British, and saved from torture and death by the Indian chief, Joseph Brant, who recognized him as a Mason.



336—What Indian chief was a Mason, fought for the British in the War of the Revolution and yet is honored by American Masons?

A Mohawk Indian, named Joseph Brant (Thayendanege), made a Mason in London 1776.



337—What Masonic interest attaches to Betsy Ross?

Married John Claypoole, a Mason.



338—Of what lodge was John Hancock a member?

St. Andrews Lodge, Boston.



339—Was Edmund Burke a Mason?

Yes; member of Jerusalem Lodge, No. 44, Clerkenwell, London.



340—Who was John Marshall?

First Chief Justice of the U. S., made a Mason in Richmond (Va.) Lodge, No. 10, in 1783 and G. M. of Va.

341—Was Benedict Arnold a Mason?

Yes, but by a unanimous vote of his lodge, Solomon's Lodge, Poughkeepsie, his name was obliterated from the minutes, 1781.

FREEMASONRY IN THE UNITED STATES

He that nothing questioneth, nothing learneth.

—Ancient Proverb.

342—What is the first mention made of Freemasonry in America?

John Moore came from England to South Carolina in 1680, and in a letter written by him in 1715 he mentions having "spent a few evenings in festivity with my Masonic brethren".



343—Who was the first Mason in America?

So far as the records run the first Mason was Gov. Jonathan Belcher of Mass., made a Mason in England 1704.



344—Where were the earliest Masonic lodges established in America?

There is a tradition that a lodge was established at Newport, R. I., in 1658.



345—Is there any other early record of lodges in America?

Yes, Benj. Franklin in 1730 asserted that several lodges existed in Pennsylvania.



346—Where and when was the first Masonic lodge regularly constituted in America?

St. John's Lodge of Boston, July 30, 1733.



347—Do any other lodges claim the distinction?

Yes, King Solomon's Lodge, Charleston, S. C., and Solomon's Lodge in Savannah, Ga.



348—When was Benjamin Franklin made a Mason?

In February 1731.

349—What positions did Benjamin Franklin occupy in Freemasonry?

J. W., 1731; J. G. W., 1732; G. M., 1734; Prov. G. M., 1735-1749.



350—Who was the first Grand Master in America?

Henry Price.



351—When was Price appointed and by whom?

In 1733, by the Earl of Crawford, G. M. of England.



352—What was the first Masonic book to be published in the United States?

Anderson's Constitutions published by Benjamin Franklin 1734.



353—Are any copies of this publication extant?

Yes; in the library of the House of the Temple, (Scottish Rite), Washington; Masonic Library, Philadelphia, and the Iowa Masonic Library, Cedar Rapids.



354—What is the famous Masonic Bible in New York?

The Bible in possession of St. John's Lodge upon which George Washington took the oath of office as President of the U. S., also used by Pres. Harding.



355—Has an effort ever been made to organize a General Grand Masonic lodge in the United States?

Yes; in 1780 when George Washington was asked to become General Grand Master.



356—Why did the movement fail?

Because the Grand Lodges of Massachusetts and Pennsylvania refused to surrender their prerogatives.



357—Did the controversy in England between "Ancients" and "Moderns" affect American Masonry?

Yes, American lodges deriving their warrants from the respective Grand Lodges of "Ancients" and "Moderns" were affected.



358—When was the reconciliation finally effected in America?

In 1817, when the rival Grand Lodges of S. C. united.

359—Does any American Grand Lodge now adhere to the "Ancient" ritual?

Yes, Pennsylvania.



360—What was Lafayette's later contact with American Masonry?

In 1824 Lafayette made a Masonic pilgrimage to the United States and was officially received and honored by many Grand Lodges.



361—What caused the anti-Masonic excitement in the United States in the year 1826?

The enemies of the Craft alleged that Masons were responsible for the disappearance of a dissolute character by the name of William Morgan, a resident of Batavia, N. Y.—1826.



362—What motive for the disappearance of Morgan was alleged?

That he published an expose of the Masonic ritual?



363—Was any proof submitted that Masons were involved in the disappearance of Morgan?

None whatever.



364—What was the anti-Masonic party?

The anti-Masonic party was organized in the early nineteenth century to put down Masonry. In 1831 the party nominated William Wirt and Amos Ellmaker as candidates for the Presidency and Vice-Presidency of the United States. Vermont sent seven votes to the Electoral College for the anti-Masonic ticket which were the only votes polled by that ticket. The party did not survive the defeat.



365—Did the Civil War split American Masonry?

No; even during the war Masons of the contending armies fraternized. Major McKinley (later president) was made a Mason in a Confederate lodge.



366—What Presidents of the United States are known to have been Masons?

Washington, Monroe, Jackson, Buchanan, Polk, Johnson, Garfield, McKinley, Roosevelt, Taft and Harding.

LANDMARKS AND CUSTOMS

*And I doubt not through the ages one increasing
purpose runs,
And the thoughts of men are widened with the
process of the suns.*

—Tennyson.

367—Why is evergreen used at Masonic funerals?

The evergreen represents the acacia which has been the emblem of immortality from time immemorial.



368—What officer in an English lodge wears the emblem of the 47th problem as his jewel?

The Past Master.



369—What is a cowan?

Literally, a dry-diker, one who built without cement, hence, a Mason without the word.



370—What is the meaning of "Lux in Tenebris"?

Light Out of Darkness; or Light Among Shadows.



371—What does "Anno Lucis" mean?

In the Year of Light; Masonically determined by adding 4,000 to the year of grace; hence 1928 A. D. is 5,928 A. L.



372—Why does the Master of a Lodge wear a hat?

As a sign of authority and superiority, in contradistinction to uncovering the head, a sign of submission.



373—To whom does the Master uncover?

To the Deity only.



374—What officer presides over a Lodge during refreshment?

The Jr. Warden.



375—What is a clandestine lodge?

A body of Masons uniting in a lodge without the consent of Grand Lodge; or, although originally constituted legally, continuing work after the revocation of its charter. (Also see Question 20.)

376—When is a lodge duly tiled?

When all ritualistic precautions have been made to protect the lodge against the approach of cowans and eavesdroppers.



377—Has a Mason a right to visit any Masonic lodge?

It is a right for which any Mason may ask; but every Lodge has the right to decline visitors.



378—What is the meaning of Pursuivant?

In former times a messenger who attended upon the king in the army; in Masonic Grand Lodges he is the official who announces names of visitors.



379—Are there any landmarks universally accepted in fact and in interpretation?

No.



380—At what passage should be Book of the Laws be opened in the various degrees?

E. A., Psalm 133; F. C., Amos 7:7-8; M. M., Ecclesiastes 12:1-7.



381—When may Grand Honors be given?

When a Masonic hall is being consecrated; when a Master is being installed; at a constitution of a new lodge; at the official visitation of a Grand Master or his deputy; and at funerals.



382—What is said of innovations in Masonry?

"It is not in the power of any man or body of men to make innovations in the body of Masonry"—Installation Charge.



383—May a Grand Master revoke the charter of a lodge?

No; he may arrest the charter which prevents the lodge from working, but Grand Lodge is the only competent authority to actually revoke the charter.



384—What is a Landmark?

A fundamental custom or usage of Freemasonry without which the institution cannot be identified as Freemasonry.

385—What is the recognized definition of a Masonic Landmark?

A certain universal, unalterable, and unrepealable fundamental which has existed from time immemorial. (Roscoe Pound.)



386—What are the Landmarks according to the Grand Lodge of Massachusetts?

(1) Monotheism, (2) Belief in Immortality, (3) V.S.L., (4) Legend of Third Degree, (5) Secrecy, (6) Operative Symbolism, (7) Mason must be freeborn male adult.



387—Do Masons indulge in any horse-play or frolic during the conferring of the degrees?

None whatever.



388—What is the highest office in Freemasonry?

Grand Master.



389—What is "Low Twelve"?

Midnight.



390—What is "High Twelve"?

Noon.



391—What does "so mote it be" mean?

Amen: may it be so.



392—When a Mason exclaims: "My name is Acacia!" what does he mean?

"I have been in the grave; I have triumphed over it by rising from the dead; and being regenerated in the process, I have a claim to life everlasting." (Dr. Oliver.)



393—What is the significance of black?

Black is always an emblem of mourning. In the French Rite the lodge is draped in black in the M. M. degree.

MAKING MASONS AT SIGHT

Nature seems to exist for the excellent. The world is upheld by the veracity of good men: they make the earth wholesome.—Emerson.

394—What is meant by “making Masons at sight”?

Initiating, passing and raising without the usual formalities; claimed as a prerogative of G. M. Is not now exercised in England and rarely ever in United States.



395—What eminent American jurist was made a Mason at sight?

Wm. Howard Taft, Chief Justice of the United States.



396—What well-known men have been made Masons at sight?

Louis Kossuth, Adm. Winfield S. Schley, John Wanamaker and William Howard Taft.



397—What are the earliest records of Grand Masters exercising their prerogative of making Masons at sight?

In 1731 Lord Lovell, G. M. of Eng., made the Duke of Lorraine, afterwards Emperor of Germany, a Mason at sight. The same honor was conferred on the Duke of Gloucester, 1766, and the Prince of Wales, 1787.

SOME MASONIC “FIRSTS”

The time to answer questions is when they are asked.—Emerson.

398—Which is the oldest Masonic lodge in the world?

Mother Kilwinning Lodge at Kilwinning, Scotland. Its origin is placed at some time in the twelfth century.



399—Who is the first known initiate into Freemasonry in England?

Sir Robert Moray, President of the Royal Society, initiated May 20, 1641, at Newcastle.

400—When was the first distinctive Masonic magazine published?

The Journal fuer Fremaurer, published in Vienna, Austria, 1784. The first English publication was the Freemason's Magazine or General and Complete Library, London, 1793.



401—When was the first known Masonic sermon preached?

Dec. 1749, by Bro. the Rev. Charles Brockwell, in Christ Church, Boston. His subject "Brotherly Love Recommended." His text, I Thess. 4:9.



402—Who was the earliest Masonic poet?

George Wither who flourished in England, born June 11, 1588, died May 2, 1667.



403—When was the first English Masonic temple dedicated?

The first "Freemasons' Hall" was dedicated in England, May 23, 1776.



404—When was the first General Masonic Charity Fund Established?

In 1724.



405—Who was the first Grand Master in America?

Henry Price; appointed April 13, 1733. Daniel Coxé was appointed in 1730 but never served.



406—Where was the first Masonic hall erected in America?

In Philadelphia in 1734.



407—What and when was the first Masonic magazine published in America?

The Freemason's Magazine & General Miscellany, 1811.



408—When was the first Masonic hall erected in America?

In Philadelphia, 1734.



409—When was the first address delivered before a Masonic Grand Lodge?

The first recorded Masonic address was delivered by the celebrated John Theophilus Desaguliers, LL.D., F. R.S. before the Grand Lodge of England in June, 1719.

GREAT MEN WHO WERE MASONS

Great men exist that there may be greater men.
—Albert Pike.

- 410—What famous German king was an active Mason?
Frederick the Great, made a Mason 1738.



- 411—What great Methodists were Masons?

John Wesley made a Mason in 1738; Samuel Wesley, one time Grand Organist of England.



- 412—What famed Scottish poet was called the poet laureate of Freemasonry?

Robert Burns.



- 413—What is the Masonic history of Robert Burns?

Scotland's beloved bard was made a Mason in Irvine in 1781. At one time he presided as Master of a lodge at Mauchline. He was crowned first poet-laureate of Freemasonry and his Masonic songs are widely used by Masons. A monument to his memory was erected by Masons at his birthplace at Kirk Alloway near Ayr. He was born Jan. 25, 1759; died July 22, 1796.



- 414—Who was Albert Pike?

A famous Masonic scholar and ritualist, born 1809, made a Mason 1850, elected Sovereign Grand Commander, Scottish Rite, S.J., 1859, entirely revised and rewrote the rituals of the Scottish Rite, honored by Masonic bodies throughout the world, died 1891.



- 415—With what Masonic classic is Albert Pike's name associated?

Morals & Dogma, the text-book of the Scottish Rite of Freemasonry.



- 416—Who was William Preston?

A Masonic ritualist; born in Edinburgh 1742. Made a Mason, London, 1763. Master of lodge when 23 years old. Endeavored to make Masonry an academy of learning.



- 417—What famous German poet was a Mason, what is his best known poem and when was he made a Mason?

Goethe; Faust; 1780.

418—What other great German poet was a Mason?
Schiller.



419—On the funeral car of what famous Mason appeared the inscriptions: "If a man is born free, he ought to govern himself," and "If a man has tyrants, he ought to dethrone them"?

Voltaire.



420—Who was Joseph Findell?

A noted German Masonic historian; born 1828, made a Mason 1856; died 1905.



421—What renowned Arctic explorers were Masons?

Elisha Kent Kane, born 1820, member Franklin Lodge, No. 134, Phila., Robert E. Peary, raised in Kane Lodge, New York City, Donald B. MacMillan, member of Kane Lodge.



422—What great American sea-fighters were Masons?

Adm. David Farragut; Stephen Decatur; Capt. John Paul Jones; Adm. Winfield Scott Schley; Capt. James Lawrence ("Don't give up the ship!")



423—Name some noted American authors who were Masons?

Gen. Lew Wallace, author of "Ben Hur," Edwin Markham, poet, Samuel L. Clemens (Mark Twain), humorist.



424—What well-known Indian fighter and scout was a Mason?

William F. Cody (Buffalo Bill), member of Platte Valley Lodge, No. Platte, Nebr.



425—What noted American author was a Mason?

Joseph Jefferson, member Concordia Lodge No. 13, Baltimore.



426—Who was Edwin Booth?

A famous English Shakespearean actor who was a Mason.



427—Who was Albert G. Mackey?

A noted Masonic authority; wrote an Encyclopedia of Freemasonry, published in middle of nineteenth century.

428—What Russian novelist describes a Masonic initiation?

Tolstoy in "War and Peace."

✧ ✧

429—Was Lord Kitchener a Mason?

Yes; at one time he was G. M. of Egypt and the Sudan; earlier he was G. M. of the Punjab in India.

✧ ✧

430—Name a famous French writer who was a Mason?

Victor Hugo.

✧ ✧

431—What Mason said—"talent may develop in solitude but character is created in society"?

Goethe.

✧ ✧

432—Who wrote the Masonic classic "The Builders"?

Joseph Fort Newton.

✧ ✧

433—Who is said to be the greatest Masonic scholar of all times?

Albert Pike.

✧ ✧

434—What world-renowned American humorist was a Mason?

Mark Twain; member of Polar Star Lodge, No. 79, of Missouri.

✧ ✧

435—What is the name of a well-known Masonic opera and who wrote it?

The Magic Flute by Mozart.

✧ ✧

436—What American poet is widely quoted by Masonic writers and speakers, who is called a Masonic poet and yet never wrote a Masonic poem?

Edwin Markham; made a Mason in Acacia Lodge, No. 92, Coloma, California.

✧ ✧

437—Who said: "The Masons' ways are a type of existence"?

Goethe.

✧ ✧

438—Was Luther Burbank a Mason?

Yes, was raised in Santa Rosa Lodge, No. 57, California, in 1921.

WOMEN AND MASONRY

439—Were women ever accepted as Freemasons?

No. There is no authentic record of a woman ever having been made a Mason. Stories of such initiations are purely legendary.



440—Why may not women be admitted to the Fraternity?

To admit women would require reorganization of entire structure of the Craft, its Constitutions, Landmarks and ritual, and is contrary to the immemorial tradition of the Order.



441—When were women in Masonry first heard of?

Clavel, a recognized German authority, asserts that "female Masonry" was instituted in France about the year 1730.



442—What form did "female Masonry" take?

In France, in 1743, an "Ordre des Felicitaires," which might be translated "Order of Happy Folks." A symbolical journey was made to the isle of Felicity. The Order boasted four degrees: Cabinboy, Captain, Commodore and Vice-Admiral. Later, in 1745, a society called "Knights and Ladies of the Anchor" was established. The Order of Woodcutters was organized in 1747 using the terminology of wood-cutting symbolically.



443—Has a Grand Lodge ever recognized these androgynous orders?

Lodges of Adoption, admitting both men and women, were established in France in 1760, and were taken under the protection of the Grand Orient of France in 1774. This action later was repudiated.



444—Could the Rite of Adoption be considered true Masonry?

No: there were certain similarities of terminology but therein the resemblance ceases. The ritual, signs, words, tokens were vastly different.



445—Is there an instance of a woman receiving the degrees of Freemasonry?

The Hon. Elizabeth St. Leger (later the wife of Richard Aldworth) it is said, received the first and sec-

ond degrees of Freemasonry about the year 1735 in Lodge No. 44 in Doneraile, Ireland. The young lady was caught eavesdropping upon a lodge meeting in her brother's castle and to protect the Craft she was obligated in the two degrees she had witnessed. She was the sister of the second Viscount Doneraile, the Master of the Lodge. Her father, the first Viscount Doneraile died in 1727. Many Masonic scholars believe the story legendary.



446—Who was Mrs. Beaton?

Mrs. Beaton was a resident of Norfolk, England, and was called a Freemason because, it is alleged, she hid herself in the wainscotting of a lodge room and overheard the work. She died July, 1802, aged 85 years.



447—In what state did a Grand Master issue an edict in which he forbade Master Masons to become members of the Eastern Star?

Pennsylvania.



448—What is Co-Masonry?

An order purporting to be Masonic in character, spirit and purpose, admitting both men and women to membership.



449—Is Co-Masonry recognized by any regular Grand Lodge in the United States?

No.



450—How many Co-Masonic Lodges are there in the world?

About 600.



451—Where did Co-Masonry originate?

In 1893, by Dr. Georges Martin, a French Senator, and Marie Deraisme, in Paris, France.



452—What is the official name of Co-Masonry?

The International Co-Masonic Order, Human Rights.

453—Does any Grand Jurisdiction recognize Co-Masonry?

The Grand Orient of France exchanges fraternal delegates and admits men members as visitors. The Grand

Lodge of France does not recognize Co-Masonry in any way.



454—Does the Co-Masonic order seek recognition of regular Grand Lodges of Freemasonry?

No.



455—Where is the headquarters of Co-Masonry in America?

Larkspur, Colo. It publishes a monthly called The Co-Mason.



456—Does Co-Masonry claim membership outside the United States?

Yes; notably in England, France and Switzerland.

NEGRO MASONRY

457—Is Negro Freemasonry regular?

A subject of dispute. Prince Hall Masonry traces its authority back to the Grand Lodge of England under a Charter granted September 20, 1784. The subsequent history is not clear, however, and the claim of regularity is clouded.



458—What is the present status of Negro Masonry in the United States?

Masonic scholars agree that the Prince Hall Grand Lodge, from which all Negro Lodges emanate, was irregular and illegal: therefore, Negro Masonry is clandestine.

FREEMASONRY 'ROUND THE WORLD

The world is my country, to do good is my religion.

—Thomas Paine.

459—When and where was the first Lodge in Africa established?

In 1736 at Cape Coast on the Gambia River.



460—Are there any Masons among the Arabs of Asia Minor?

Yes; Masonry is strong among the Arabs. Prince Feisal and his father, the King of the Hejaz, are Masons.



461—Is there a Masonic Lodge in Damascus?

Yes; recently the Grand Lodge of New York chartered a Lodge in Damascus to work in Arabic. Its name is Ibrahim il Khalil (Abraham the Beloved).



462—When was Masonry established in the Argentine Republic?

It is known that Masonic lodges were working in the Argentine as early as 1846.



463—Briefly what is the history of Freemasonry in Austria?

Freemasonry was introduced into Austria in 1742 and a Grand Lodge established. Maria Theresa suppressed the Order in 1764, imprisoning many of its members. The Craft was revived under Joseph II in 1780 but his successor, Francis II, dissolved the lodges, and the Fraternity remained under the ban until recently.



464—When was Masonry introduced into Belgium?

Masonry was introduced in Belgium early in the nineteenth century, a Grand Orient being established in 1833.



465—When was Masonry introduced into Bohemia?

First true Mason in Bohemia was Count Antonius Spork (1662-1738). Masonry regularly established 1726. Dissolved as result of Jesuit intrigue, 1773. Existed secretly until 1922. Now extensive and influential.

466—When was Freemasonry organized in Brazil?

The Grand Orient of Brazil was organized in 1821 and soon after Dom Pedro I was proclaimed Grand Master.



467—Is there a Chinese Freemasonry?

As we understand Freemasonry, No. The so-called "Chinese Freemasons of the World" is a political association and is not recognized by any regular Grand Lodge. There is a Chinese society called the Hung Society using the tools of the building art as symbols but it is not Masonic.



468—When was Masonry established in Denmark and who is the present Grand Master?

1743 under a German charter; King Christian.



469—How many Lodges are there at the present time under the jurisdiction of the United Grand Lodge of England?

4,300, of which 700 are outside England.



470—What is the Masonic Million Memorial Fund?

A fund estimated to exceed \$4,000,000 being raised by English Masons to build a great Masonic temple in London as a memorial to the Masons who died in the World War.



471—Who is the present (1928) Grand Master of England?

The Duke of Connaught and Strathern, uncle of King George V, born 1850, elected G. M. 1900.



472—Who preceeded the present G. M. of England?

Albert Edward, Prince of Wales, later King Edward VII.



473—When was Freemasonry introduced into France?

Probably about 1720.



474—Was Masonry welcomed in France?

Yes, at first. It was taken up by the Nobility but incurring the suspicion of the Inquisition Freemasonry was proscribed by that institution at Paris, Dec. 14, 1732. Bitter persecutions followed.

475—What Masonic contact was there between Benjamin Franklin and Voltaire?

Franklin served as S. W. at the Lodge of the Nine Sisters, at Paris, when Voltaire was raised a Mason, 1778.



476—Was Napoleon a Mason?

Yes.



477—What famous General of Napoleon's staff was a Mason?

Joachim Murat, Grand Duke of Berg and Cleves, King of the Two Sicilies, was Grand Commander of the Supreme Council of Napoli.



478—What brothers of Napoleon were Masons?

Joseph Bonaparte, King of Spain and G. M. of the Grand Orient of Naples and France; and Louis Bonaparte, King of Holland.



479—What are the present Grand jurisdictions in France?

The Grand Lodge of France, requiring belief in God and immortality and the Bible; the Grand Orient requiring no religious professions.



480—How did the French Revolution affect Freemasonry?

Virtually destroyed it. In 1796 only eighteen lodges survived.



481—Besides the Grand Orient and the Grand Lodge is there any other Grand jurisdiction in France now?

Yes; the National Grand Lodge, following the customs and precedents of Anglo-Saxon Masonry.



482—When was the first Masonic lodge established in Germany?

At Cologne in 1716 but it soon became defunct. The Grand Lodge of Scotland established a lodge at Brunswick in 1738. The first Grand Lodge was organized in 1741.



483—How many Grand Lodges were there in Germany?

Eight. The Senior body is the Grand National Mother Lodge of the Three Globes, founded in 1740 with Frederick the Great as Grand Master.

484—What effect did the World War have upon German Masonry?

In a fit of pique and anger all the German Grand Lodges severed fraternal relations with all other Grand Lodges of the World.



485—Under what Grand Lodge do the Masonic lodges in Hawaii work?

California.



486—When was Freemasonry established in India?

1740.



487—How many Masonic lodges are there in India now?

Over three hundred.



488—Is there a Masonic Grand Lodge in India?

No, the lodges in India are under the jurisdiction of the Grand Lodges of England, Scotland and Ireland; except a few lodges under the Grand Lodge of All Scottish Freemasonry in India.



489—Are natives of India admitted to the Masonic lodges?

Yes, under an edict of the Grand Master of England, 1842, Hindoos and Mohammedans are eligible for membership.



490—When was Masonry introduced into Holland?

Soon after 1717.



491—What was its history?

Severe persecutions, 1735. Rehabilitated with independent Grand Lodge 1756. At present, while not large in membership, Craft is very influential.



492—What famous Italian liberators were Masons?

Garibaldi and Mazzini, both of whom served as G. M.



493—What Masonic Grand Master led the Italian armies of liberation into Rome in 1870?

Garibaldi.

494—When was the Grand Lodge of Ireland duly constituted?

On St. John the Baptist's Day, 1725, with the Earl of Rosse as G. M.



495—What is the Masonic story in Ireland?

In 1753 there were 37 lodges on the Irish Grand Lodge register. Today there are approximately 650 lodges.



496—When was Freemasonry introduced into Italy?

In 1735.



497—What was the subsequent history in Italy?

In 1861 twenty-two lodges met at Turin and organized the Grand Lodge of Italy. Masonry played important part in patriotic movement that culminated in the march on Rome, 1870.



498—What were the later developments?

Italian Masonry split in 1873 and the Grand Orient was established. In 1901 another Grand Orient was founded. In 1922 the Order was suppressed by an edict of Mussolini.



499—Has Masonry been introduced into Japan?

The Grand Lodge of England established a Lodge in Yokohama in 1865. There are several Lodges for Britishers and Americans. The Japanese government forbids Japanese to become members of secret societies.



**500—What Filipino patriot and martyr was a Mason?
Is there a G. L. of the Philippines?**

Jose Rizal, executed by the Spanish. The lodges in the Philippines were formerly under the jurisdiction of California; now there is an independent G. L.



501—How was Masonry introduced into Portugal?

Several noble Portuguese instituted a Lodge, under charter for the G. L. of England, 1735.



502—What were the subsequent developments?

Persecutions 1780 to 1805. Then comparative peace.



503—When was Freemasonry introduced into Rumania?

Early in this century by the Supreme Council, Scottish Rite of France; later this jurisdiction was surrendered

to the National Grand Lodge of Rumania. There are about 15 Lodges in that country.



504—When was Masonry first heard of in Russia?

Freemason's Calendar of 1777 claims first Lodge in Russia was the Lodge of Perfect Unity, No. 414 E. C., established at St. Petersburg in 1771.



505—Is there any further record?

In 1772 the G. L. of Eng. appointed Senator John Yelaguin Prov. G. M. of Russia.



506—What was the subsequent history of the Craft in Russia?

Active until subjected to persecution in 1826, then silence for 80 years; Masonry revived in 1908 under authority G. L. of France; suppressed by the Fourth Congress of the Communist International at Moscow, 1922.



507—Was Peter the Great a Mason?

No authentic record, said to have been initiated in England.



508—When was the Grand Lodge of Scotland constituted?

In 1736, although independent lodges had existed for many years previously.



509—When was Freemasonry introduced into South Africa?

In 1772. Now covered concurrently by four Grand Jurisdictions—Netherlands, England, Scotland, Ireland. The Craft strong and growing.



510—Who introduced Freemasonry into Spain?

Duke of Wharton, British Ambassador; earlier (1722) Wharton had been G. M. of England.



511—When was Masonry introduced into Spain?
1728.



512—What noble Spanish Grand Master was excommunicated?

The Infante of Spain, Don Francisco De Paula Borbon, G. M. of the Grand Orient of Spain and Supreme

Commander of the Scottish Rite was excommunicated by the pope in 1829 because of his Masonic activities.



513—When was the first Lodge founded in Sweden?
1735.



514—What is the peculiar characteristic of Scandanavian Masonry?

It is Christian in ritual and character, embodying many of the distinctive teachings of Swedenborg.



515—Are there any Lodges in Syria?

Yes; four Lodges have been chartered by the Grand Lodge of New York, and there are others. A Syrian Grand Lodge is projected.

QUAINT AND CURIOUS FACTS

A prudent question is one half of wisdom.—Bacon.

516—How many Masons are there?

In the United States (1928), approximately 3,750,000; in all English-speaking countries, approximately 4,350,000; in other countries, 400,000; total in the world, approximately 4,750,000.



517—Which Grand Lodges use F. & A. M. and which A. F. & A. M.?

Twenty-three Grand Lodges use A. F. & A. M.,—Ola., Colo., Del., Ida., Ill., Ia., Kan., Me., Md., Mass., Mo., Mont., Nebr., New Mex., N. C., N. D., Okla., Ore., S. D., Tex., Va., W. Va. and Wyo. Twenty-two use F. & A. M.,—Ariz., Ark., Calif., Conn., Fla., Ga., Ind., Ky., La., Mich., Miss., Nev., N. H., N. J., N. Y., O., R. I., Tenn., Utah, Ut., Wash. and Wisc. D. C. uses F. A. M., the second A standing for "and."



518—What is meant by "Accepted" Masons?

When the Operative Masonic lodges were falling into decline with the close of the cathedral building era, scholars were admitted to membership even though they had no intention of engaging in actual Masonic work. They were called "Accepted Masons."

519—Are Masonic lodges numbered in all U. S. jurisdictions?

Every jurisdiction numbers its lodges except Mass. In that state the custom was discontinued in 1804.



520—What Masonic Lodge is farthest north?

Dawson City, Alaska, 225 miles within the Arctic Circle.



521—Are there any blind Freemasons?

Yes, Masons blinded after they received the degrees. A team of blind Masons recently conferred the First Degree at Queen City Lodge, Toronto, Canada. In London, Eng., is a lodge specially interested in improving the condition of the blind. Its name is Lux in Tenebris (Light Among Shadows).



522—What is the ladder of Kadosh?

The Ladder of Kadosh consists of seven steps; Justice, Equity, Kindness, Good Faith, Labor, Patience and Intelligence.



523—What does Kadosh mean?

Kadosh is a Hebrew word meaning Holy.



524—Who were the Illuminati?

A spurious Masonic society, originating in Bavaria, 1776. Never recognized as Masonic. Spread through Germany and France but declined and disappeared early in the nineteenth century.



525—What is the Rite of Mizraim?

A spurious Masonic rite was originated by one Lechangeur in Italy, in 1805, of which he declared himself Superior Grand Conservator. This rite have never been conferred outside Naples, and is now non-existent.



526—Whence came the idea of "riding a goat"?

In ancient symbolism the goat Mendes typified all that was evil. Among the Greeks and the Romans the god Pan was depicted as half-goat, signifying that nature was half evil. The enemies of Freemasonry originated the idea that candidates rode the goat, meaning the devil.



527—What was the ancient sign of silence?

A finger laid across the lips.

528—What does the key mean as used in the English E. A. degree?

The tongue,—always ready to speak in a brother's defense.



529—What was the best known early parody of Freemasonry?

Ancient Noble Order of Gormogons.



530—What ancient working tool is mentioned in English ritual, the operative use of which is lost?

The Broached Thurnel.



531—Who wrote the story with Masonic implications entitled: "The Man Who Would Be King"?

Kipling.



532—What is the Master's Piece?

A piece of work, usually a stone, presented by the apprentice to prove that he was worthy to be made a Master.



533—Who wrote the famous Masonic hymn: "Solemn strikes the funeral chime"?

David Vinton, published 1816.



534—When was the Grand Lodge of California established?

April 19, 1850.



535—Was Joseph Smith, the founder of Mormonism, a Mason?

It is said he was made a Mason at sight by the Grand Master of Illinois. Later he was expelled from the Craft. There is much Masonic symbolism, so it is said, in Mormon ceremonials.



536—Was President Lincoln a Mason?

No.



537—What, besides the lion's paw, was a popular Masonic mark in early times?

The broad arrow.



538—What is the meaning of the motto, "Audi, Vidi, Tace," found on Masonic medals and documents?

Hear, See, Be Silent!

539—What is the “Knife and Fork Degree”?

A sarcastic allusion to Masons who take a greater delight in the social activities of the lodge than in its more serious affairs. Used first by Dermott in Ahiman Rezon.



540—Who were the Four Crowned Ones, and what famous English lodge is named after them?

Four Christian stone-masons in Rome, ordered by the Emperor Diocletian to carve a statue, refused to do so on the ground that it was an idol. They were thrown into the Tiber alive in leaden coffins. The Quatuor Coronati Lodge, No. 2076, London, a lodge for research.



541—Where can I find reports of instances of Masonic fidelity and assistance in time of stress and danger, as illustrating the strength of our mystic tie?

There are many such scattered through our literature. Low Twelve, by E. S. Ellis (Macoy Co., New York), is perhaps the collection of instances you are looking for, which you will find very interesting and often thrilling.



542—What is a “Lewis”?

An instrument made use of by Operative Masons to lift heavy stones. In Speculative Masonry symbolizes the son of a Mason. Not used in American terminology except in Pennsylvania. Used also to signify the son of a Mason who receives special privilege of being initiated before he is 21 years of age.



543—What was the “Mason’s Dame”?

The wife of the inn-keeper at whose tavern the Lodge met in early days; she was sworn so that she could serve refreshments when necessary.



544—What were the Pillars of Enoch?

Two pillars said to have been set up by Enoch, who, being warned of the impending deluge, erected the pillars and engraved thereon the details of the creation, of the arts and sciences, etc. Variouslly stated to be of brass, marble, or brick. This is an early Masonic legend.



545—What is the line?

One of the working tools of a Past Master.



546—Is the fish a Masonic emblem?

Formerly the Grand Master wore a silver fish upon his person.

ROMAN CATHOLIC CHURCH AND FREEMASONRY

*The spirit of truth and the spirit of freedom: they
are the pillars of society.—Ibsen.*

547—May a Roman Catholic be a Mason?

So far as Freemasonry is concerned, yes. Freemasonry discriminates against no man because of his religion.



548—Is the Roman Catholic Church friendly to Freemasonry?

No; the Roman Catholic Church forbids its members to become Masons.



549—How has the Roman Catholic Church shown its hostility to the Craft?

By papal bulls condemning the Masonic fraternity.



550—When and by whom was the first bull against Freemasonry issued?

By Pope Clement XII on May 29, 1738.



551—Have later popes endorsed the bull of Clement XII?

Yes, notably Benedict XIV in 1751, Pius VII in 1821, Leo XII in 1825, Gregory XVI in 1832, Pius IX in 1846 and 1865, and Leo XIII in 1884.



552—Why does the Roman Catholic Church condemn Freemasonry?

On the grounds that Freemasonry is a secret society, is a humanistic religion teaching heretical doctrines, is a political organization allied with movements that are liberal, democratic and modernistic, and encourages free thought, secular education, individual independence and the freedom of the state from control by the church.



553—Has Masonry ever retaliated by any hostile acts against the Church?

No.

554—Has any answer ever been made to the encyclicals of the popes against Masonry?

The most famous reply was that of Albert Pike, at the time Sovereign Grand Commander of the Scottish Rite, S.J., answering the attack of Pope Leo XIII, entitled "Humanum Genus," promulgated April 20, 1884.



555—Has there ever been a Roman Catholic Grand Master of Masons?

Yes; Viscount Montacute, a Roman Catholic (b. 1686, d. 1767) was G. M. of England 1732; and Benedict Barnewall, 4th Viscount Kingsland, also a Roman Catholic, was G. M. of Ireland, 1733-4.